

EHAP PROGRESS UPDATE



Extreme Heat Action Planning

July 2025 – June 2026

Extreme Heat Action Plan. In the second year of implementation, new State investments help create **green, resilient shared spaces** to keep communities and neighborhoods cool, support **access to swimming and play areas**, and build community resilience by supporting **Community Resilience Hubs**, community **cooling centers**, and **cooling at home**. New and updated resources support adaptation to extreme heat, including new funding opportunities to create public cooling spaces through **Clean Green Schools**, **NY SWIMS**, and **NY PLAYS**; and assistance to access cooling at home through **HEAP** and **the Essential Plan Cooling Program**.

HIGHLIGHTS FROM 2025

CREATING GREEN AND COOL PUBLIC SPACES

State investments are transforming public spaces to reduce urban heat while serving as places for communities to gather and connect. New funding is available to support green, cool, and comfortable spaces, including [schools](#), [playgrounds](#), and [public pools](#), that serve the youngest members of our communities. Investments are creating new spaces and enhancing existing ones, including prioritizing disadvantaged communities (DACs) to help expand equitable access to outdoor cooling spaces.

EXPANDING ACCESS TO PUBLIC COOLING

DEC's [Climate Smart Communities \(CSC\) grant program](#) provided \$2 million in funds for new cooling centers and heat emergency plans in 2025. In her 2026 State of the State address, Governor Hochul announced a new grant program provide \$10 million for establishing [Community Resilience Hubs](#). New DOH [cooling center guidance](#) provides best practices for establishing cooling centers and supports consistent services at those sites.

SUPPORTING ACCESS TO COOLING AT HOME

In 2025, DOH launched the [Essential Plan Cooling Program](#). In 2026, the program is expanding eligibility to offer free air conditioners to more members of the Essential Plan, covering 16 qualifying conditions. Expanded eligibility will help provide in-home cooling to more people with health conditions that may be exacerbated by heat. This will complement assistance available in 2026 through the [Home Energy Assistance Program \(HEAP\) Cooling program](#). In addition, the Public Service Commission (PSC) announced [uniform extreme heat utility protections](#) for customers to prevent utility shutoffs during extreme heat events.

PROTECTING WORKERS

In 2024, DOL launched extreme weather guidance, including extreme heat guidance, to keep workers safe. In 2025, DOL developed additional resources, including a new [bilingual wallet card](#) and templates for [Heat Illness and Injury Prevention Plans](#) (also in [Spanish](#)). Site visits and vulnerable worker outreach in collaboration with local partners were also expanded. Governor Hochul announced [the NYS Insurance Fund equipment credit for small businesses](#).

KEY RESOURCES AT A GLANCE

New York State maintains a wide range of informational resources, individual assistance, grant funding, tools, and data. Selected important resources are listed and linked below.

HEAT AND HEALTH

- DOH [Extreme Heat Advice](#)
- DOH [Cooling Center Finder](#)
- DHSES [Extreme Heat Safety](#)
- DOL [Protecting Outdoor Workers from Extreme Heat](#) (also in [Spanish](#))
- DOL [Extreme Weather Guidance Hub](#)

EXTREME HEAT MONITORING

- DOH [Heat Risk and Illness Dashboard](#)
- CDC [Heat & Health Tracker](#)
- NWS/CDC [HeatRisk Tool](#)
- NOAA/NWS [2-Week Probabilistic Extremes Forecast](#)

INDIVIDUAL ASSISTANCE

- OTDA [HEAP Cooling Assistance Benefit](#)
- DOH [Empire Essential Cooling Program](#)
- NYSERDA [Programs for Residents and Homeowners](#)
- NYS [Clean Heat](#)
- HCR [Weatherization Assistance Program](#)

GRANT FUNDING FOR COMMUNITY ACTION

- DEC [Bond Act Funding Finder](#)
- AGM [Urban Farms and Community Gardens Grant Program](#)
- DHSES [Hazard Mitigation Grant Program](#)
- DEC [CSC Grant Program](#)
- DEC [Urban and Community Forestry Program](#)
- DEC [Environmental Justice Grants](#)

TOOLS AND DATA

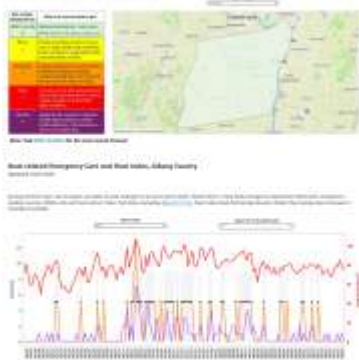
- DOH [Heat Vulnerability Index](#) (NYC has its own HVI)
- DEC [Urban Heat Island \(UHI\) maps](#)
- NYS [Climate Impacts Assessment](#)

HEAT PLANNING JUST GOT EASIER WITH NEW AND UPDATED TOOLS

To effectively adapt to extreme heat, communities need reliable tools that help them understand where, when, and how heat is impacting them. The State is offering a suite of tools that help communities plan for and adapt to extreme heat.

DOH Heat Risk and Illness Dashboard

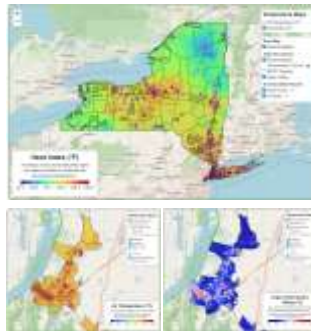
DOH released a new dashboard that allows users to track heat health outcomes on the local and statewide level.



Link | [DOH Dashboard](#)

DEC Urban Heat Island Maps

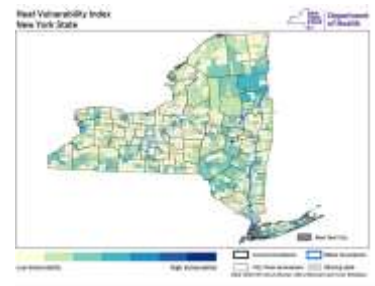
Urban Heat Island maps provide statewide exposure data to help communities identify and address heat islands.



Link | [DEC UHI tools](#)

DOH Heat Vulnerability Index

DOH is making updates to the State's heat vulnerability index (HVI), helping communities identify areas with vulnerable populations.



Link | [DOH HVI](#)

DHSES MitigateNY

MitigateNY is New York State's central hub for hazard mitigation planning, offering data, tools, and guidance.

Link | [MitigateNY](#)

NYS Climate Impacts Assessment

The New York State Climate Impacts Assessment provides climate projections for NYS and information on impacts of climate change.

Link | [Impacts Assessment](#)

NYS Disadvantaged Communities

Maps help identify areas throughout the State that meet the disadvantaged community criteria as defined by the CJWG.

Link | [NYS DAC Map](#)

EXTREME HEAT IN NEW YORK STATE

In 2025, New York State saw several periods of high heat, including an early season heat wave that broke several temperature records across the state. In the greater New York City metropolitan area, several heat records were set in June, including the hottest day since July 2012 and the hottest June on record.¹ (Nationally, June was the 7th-warmest month in the 131-year record). The North Country, Upstate New York, and Western New York saw fewer extreme highs than Long Island, New York City, and the lower Hudson Valley; however, temperatures were still above average, with heat events occurring in all areas of the State, including the Adirondacks.

The table below offers an overview of some extreme-heat-related statistics for 2025. Detailed statistics for New York State regions are available from the [National Weather Service](#) (NWS) and individual NWS station data (daily station data).

Extreme Heat in 2025 ²	NUMBER OF DAYS				Heat Waves
	≥ 80°F	≥ 85°F	≥ 90°F	≥ 95°F	
Albany	74	42	18	2	2
Buffalo	65	30	8	0	1
New York City (Central Park)	87	44	14	6	2
Syracuse	73	45	17	2	2
Watertown	53	28	4	0	0

From May 1 to September 29, 2025, extreme heat resulted in 4,007 heat-related emergency department (ED) visits in New York State, (excluding New York City, which reports data separately³), compared to 3,213 in 2024 and a historical baseline of 2,731 visits (average cumulative visits for the years 2021-2024).⁴ New York City reported 1130 heat-related ED visits. Additional heat health data is available at the DOH [Heat Risk and Illness Dashboard](#).

¹ <https://www.weather.gov/okx/June2025heat>
² Data reflect regions used in the NYS Climate Impacts Assessment (CIA); see appendix, https://nysclimateimpacts.org/wp-content/uploads/2024/01/Appendix-Projections_Tables-1.pdf. Heat waves are defined as three or more consecutive days with maximum temperatures at or above 90°F.
³ New York City reports environment- and health-related data at <https://a816-dohbesp.nyc.gov/IndicatorPublic/>
⁴ Heat health outcomes for 2024 exclude NYC, based on Department of Health Heat Surveillance Report (https://www.health.ny.gov/statistics/environmental/heat_dashboard/). New York City reports their own data at <https://a816-dohbesp.nyc.gov/IndicatorPublic/>

2025 IN REVIEW: ADVANCING EHAP GOALS

EHAP Working Group member agencies reported significant progress across all **49 actions** in all **four action tracks**, thereby advancing the **five overarching goals** of the plan.⁵

2025 HEAT ADAPTATION SUCCESSES BY THE NUMBERS

GOAL 1

PROMOTE COMMUNITY HEALTH, WELL- BEING

- **20,984 households** served by the HEAP Cooling program between April 15 and June 23, 2025.
- **\$30,000 in technical assistance awards to ten local health departments** to work with partners on climate and health adaptation priorities.
- **215 work site visits** for extreme heat compliance assistance and enforcement actions related to the OSHA National Emphasis Program on Heat from June 2024 to March 2026.
- Throughout 2025, DOL visited over **10,000 farm workers** in person to share know-your-rights information.

GOAL 2

BUILD LOCAL CAPACITY TO EQUITABLY ADAPT

- **Awarded \$8 million through** Climate Smart Communities grants for **11 local heat-adaptation projects**, funding response equipment, creek daylighting, cooling centers, A/C recycling, and UHI mitigation.
- **Supported 32 community-based organizations** with \$6 million from DEC's Environmental Justice Community Impact Grants.

GOAL 3

SUPPORT A RESILIENT BUILT ENVIRONMENT

- More than **\$100 million** is available to make clean energy upgrades, including heating and cooling, in public schools through the Clean Green Schools initiative. Since inception, NYSERDA has awarded more than **\$82 million to 14 installation projects in 45 buildings**.
- HCR served **over 10,00 housing units** using Climate Friendly Homes, Weatherization, and Sustainable Energy Resources for Consumers funds.
- More than **\$125 million is available for energy efficiency and electrification upgrades** through NYSERDA's Affordable Multifamily Program Upstate (AMP Up), which will deliver energy savings while improving quality of life and reducing heat risk for occupants.

GOAL 4

STRENGTHEN LIFELINE INFRASTRUCTURE

- **7,841 MW of solar capacity** and **529 MW of storage capacity** was installed on New York State's distribution network by the end of 2025.
- MTA deployed and now operates **82 new, all-electric buses** across all four boroughs of New York City and made significant investments in supporting infrastructure.
- PSC expanded **the Energy Affordability Program to provide financial relief** for income-eligible customers by making their electric and/or natural gas utility bills more affordable through monthly discounts.

GOAL 5

PROMOTE ACCESS TO ECOSYSTEM BENEFITS

- **\$2.5 million** in grant funds **supported 51 organizations** through the Urban Farms and Community Gardens Grant program.
- **\$63 million** in capital grants fund **21 projects to expand safe swimming** access across New York State through the NY SWIMS initiative.

⁵ See [Extreme Heat Action Plan](#) p. 21

EMERGENT CHALLENGES AND OPPORTUNITIES

Emergent Challenges and Opportunities: Agencies made significant progress across all action tracks. New tools and resources made available as part of EHAP are providing a strong foundation for continued implementation in the coming year.

However, uncertainty related to changes in federal policies and associated shifts in funding are presenting emergent challenges that may affect EHAP implementation in the future.

- **Energy affordability and the associated implications for equitable access to cooling at home** remain a significant challenge across the nation, including New York State. Federal funding uncertainties constrain available resources to address the rising costs for home cooling and energy more broadly. However, the PSC has established an energy affordability policy for New York State, with the goal to hold the energy burden for low-income households to no more than six percent of household income. To achieve this goal, the PSC established the [Energy Affordability Program \(EAP\)](#), which provides monthly bill discounts to low-income households, or those with annual income at or below 60 percent of State Median Income. In July 2025, the PSC authorized an Enhanced Energy Affordability Program (EEAP), which extends the energy affordability policy to households at or below 100% of State Median Income and provides bill payment assistance to households. In addition, the PSC has directed ratepayer funds to weatherization and energy efficiency programs, such as EmPower+, to reduce household energy consumption and costs.
- **Federal action on worker protections:** In August 2024, the federal Occupational Health and Safety Administration (OSHA) issued a notice of proposed rulemaking to establish a Heat Injury and Illness Prevention Standard for outdoor and indoor work settings. The proposed rule would require employers to protect their workers when the heat index exceeded 80 degrees, by providing mandatory rest breaks, worker training, and a written heat illness, injury and prevention plan, among other requirements. After a substantial public comment period ended in 2025, during which DOL submitted comments to support the efforts, the federal government has taken no further steps to finalize the rule and has not indicated a target date for final action.

In the absence of a federal rule to protect workers from heat, DOL continues to educate employers and workers about the importance of workplace safety measures during hot weather. DOL offers formal guidance to employers on how to best protect their workers, conducts site visits to spread information to workers, offers on-site extreme heat compliance assistance and enforcement actions related to the OSHA National Emphasis Program on Heat, and is preparing a heat safety training video that will be publicly available starting in summer 2026.

FROM SCHOOLS TO PARKS AND PLAYGROUNDS — COOL OUTDOOR SPACES FOR ALL AGES

Track: 3 – Support Resilient Built Environments & 4 – Prioritize Ecosystem-Based Adaptation

Actions: T3.08, T3.12, 4.05 **Involved Agencies:** NYSERDA, NYSED, OPRHP, DEC

With a focus on disadvantaged communities, the State is investing in community spaces that deepen social connections and create new healthy, clean, and cool public green spaces. Investments focus on green schoolyards, access to swimming, parks, community forests, community gardens, and community playgrounds as spaces that serve young people and connect communities across generations.

- **Funding green, cool schoolyards:** NYSERDA, in partnership with DEC, plans to invest Environmental Bond Act funds for [green schoolyard projects](#) in its [Clean Green Schools program](#) to support projects that transform schoolyards in priority districts into green, cool, and healthy outdoor spaces.
- **Expanding access to swimming and investing in playgrounds:** OPRHP and DASNY support playgrounds and public swimming facilities. In August 2025, the [second round of NY SWIMS](#) made \$53 million in capital grants available to expand access to safe swimming facilities. In January 2026, Governor Hochul [announced NY PLAYS](#), a \$67.5 million competitive grant program to support new and renovated public playgrounds. Both programs are overseen by OPRHP and administered by DASNY.
- **Providing access to the outdoors:** Existing OPRHP and DEC programs help connect New Yorkers with the outdoors by offering free or discounted access for seniors and veterans through programs such as the Lifetime Liberty Pass, Golden Park Program, and Patriot Plan Benefit, and by supporting transportation, access to swim instruction, and access to outdoor education through the [Connect Kids program](#).

These efforts advance several goals of the Extreme Heat Action Plan and are part of Governor Hochul's Unplug and Play initiative that connects young people with the outdoors.

Available Resources:

- NYS [Environmental Bond Act](#)
- [NY SWIMS](#)
- [NY PLAYS](#)
- NYSERDA [Clean Green Schools](#)
- OPRHP [Connect Kids](#)
- OPRHP [Golden Park Program](#)
- OPRHP [Lifetime Liberty Pass](#)
- OPRHP [Patriot Plan Benefit](#)

COOLING CENTERS AND RESILIENCE HUBS TO SUPPORT COMMUNITY CAPACITY

Track: 1 – Build Capacity for Local Action & 2 – Preparedness, Communication, and Workers’ Safety

Actions: T1.02, T2.02, T2.05 **Involved Agencies:** DEC, DOH

New York State is partnering with community anchors (from libraries to educational centers and community centers) to build community resilience to extreme heat and other climate and extreme weather hazards. Place-based organizations serve vital roles within communities, as their physical locations are places of connection and provide access to resources, information, and services.

- **Enhancing access to cooling centers:** Place-based organizations often operate cooling centers as spaces for residents to cool down during hot weather. To support organizations in establishing new cooling centers, and to help ensure consistent services, DOH released [cooling center guidance](#). DOH is also updating the [Heat Vulnerability Index](#) (HVI), which communities can use with the [Disadvantaged Communities Criteria maps](#) to help identify populations of people that may be more vulnerable to extreme heat. DOH maintains the [Cooling Center Finder](#) to help residents find the nearest cooling center. DEC is offering funding through the [Climate Smart Communities grant program](#) to establish cooling centers.
- **Strengthening services provided by cooling centers:** DOH is supporting communities in establishing and promoting cooling centers, as well as reducing barriers to accessing cooling centers. To expand the services provided at cooling centers, DOH has released complementary guidance for cooling centers to also serve as [clean air centers](#). As part of DOH’s technical assistance program for local health departments, DOH has awarded funding to Ontario County Public Health to establish climate resource centers at libraries that already serve as informal warming and cooling centers. The project expands services at these sites by providing resource training for staff, standardized climate resource toolkits, and clear referral pathways to support residents.
- **Creating Community Resilience Hubs:** Governor Hochul is launching a [new competitive grant program providing \\$10 million to support community-based organizations](#) in environmental justice and disadvantaged communities in strengthening local preparedness and response capabilities. This new DEC program will prioritize the development of Community Resilience Hubs, which are trusted neighborhood locations equipped to support residents during extreme weather — including extreme heat — and other emergencies. DEC is also collaborating with the Cornell Atkinson Center for Sustainability to develop a [“playbook” for Community Resilience Hubs](#) and support local pilot projects.

Available Resources:

- DEC [Environmental Justice Grant Programs](#)
- DOH [Heat Vulnerability Index](#)
- DOH [Cooling Center Guidance](#)
- DOH [Cooling Center Finder](#)
- DEC [Climate Smart Communities Grant Program](#)

COOL CORRIDORS FOR RESILIENT NEIGHBORHOODS

Track: 1 – Build Capacity for Local Action & 3 – Support Resilient Built Environments

Actions: T1.01, T1.03, T3.10 **Involved Agencies:** DEC, DOS, DOT, SUNY

DEC is collaborating with DOS, DOT and partners at SUNY University at Buffalo (SUNY UB) and SUNY College of Environmental Science and Forestry (SUNY ESF) to support cool corridors for resilient neighborhoods. New and forthcoming tools support communities in planning and implementing neighborhood and streetscape (i.e., street design) solutions.

- **Enhanced mapping tools help communities plan heat-resilient streetscapes:** DEC is collaborating with SUNY ESF to enhance existing [tools that map extreme heat exposure](#) and help identify urban heat islands. SUNY ESF and DEC are updating the tools to support communities in identifying particularly hot streets. Along with [DAC maps](#) and [DOH's HVI](#), these tools can help prioritize neighborhood-scale solutions and plan cool street and transit corridors.
- **New project to help communities design cool corridors:** DEC is partnering with SUNY UB to develop a cool corridors toolkit. The toolkit will include design recommendations, guidance, and other resources to support local communities in equitably planning, designing, and implementing cool street and transit corridors.
- **Pilot projects innovate natural UHI solutions:** DEC and DOT are advancing "[Miyawaki mini-forests](#)", using innovative approaches to dense plantings of small-stock native trees and shrubs, grasses, and perennials. DOT is expanding on these efforts in select locations on road Right of Ways (ROW), including to reduce urban heat, mitigate other climate risks, and provide additional ecological and community benefits. A pilot mini-forest was established as part of the removal of an interchange ramp in a DAC neighborhood -- with more locations to follow soon.
- **Grants help fund cool corridors:** DOT funds numerous locally led projects with State and federal funds to facilitate streetscape improvements that integrate tree plantings and green infrastructure, including through the [Complete Streets programs](#). DOS offers a range of resources to support resilience in streetscape and community planning, for example, the [Smart Growth Community Planning program](#), the [Countywide Resilience Planning program](#), and [others](#). The State funds projects that prioritize nature-based solutions, including through DEC's [Climate Smart Communities grant program](#) and [Urban and Community Forestry Grants](#) and EFC's [Green Resilience Grant and the Green Innovation Grant programs](#).

Available Resources:

- DEC [UHI Maps](#)
- DOT [Complete Streets Programs](#)
- DOS [Resilience Programs](#)
- DEC [Climate Smart Communities Grant Program](#)
- DEC [Urban and Community Forestry Grants](#)
- EFC [Green Resilience Grant and the Green Innovation Grant programs](#)

DEEPENING COMMUNITY PREPAREDNESS FOR EXTREME HEAT

Track: 2 – Preparedness, Communication, and Workers’ Safety

Actions: T2.01, T2.05, T2.06 **Involved Agencies:** DHSES, DOH, DOL

DHSES serves as the primary State response and recovery agency and is a central partner for local communities in their emergency planning and response efforts. DHSES applies an all-hazards approach in planning for and responding to emergencies, including extreme heat. To enhance the State’s coordinated response to extreme heat emergencies, DHSES developed an [extreme heat-specific annex](#) to the [State Comprehensive Emergency Management Plan](#), which was released in July 2023 and updated in March 2026. DHSES continues to coordinate and support communications for extreme heat emergencies and preparedness.

- **Enhancing public extreme heat communications:** The [New York State Weather Risk Communication Center](#) continues to conduct research and develop heat-specific products for summer 2026. DHSES continues to work with SUNY University at Albany to ensure extreme heat communications across agencies are informed by social science research. The NYS Watch Center sends readiness emergency alerts to county emergency managers with resources for different emergency alert considerations, which include extreme heat. DHSES rolled out a new text alerting platform called 333111, available for all New Yorkers to sign up and receive emergency and weather alerts, including extreme heat alerts, to their phones.
- **Protecting summer campers from extreme weather threats:** Pursuant to Governor Hochul’s [2026 State of the State initiative](#), DOH, in partnership with DHSES and local health departments, is supporting preparedness efforts for summer camps at greatest risk of extreme weather. This effort will help camps incorporate extreme weather readiness into safety plans.
- **Coordinating safety, including from extreme heat, at major public events:** DHSES is leading the State’s public safety coordination for major events taking place this summer, including the FIFA World Cup and America 250 celebrations that will take place in and around New York State in June and July.
- **Educating the public on emergency preparedness:** DHSES, in partnership with NYS Division of Military and Naval Affairs, conducted more Citizen Preparedness Corps (CPC) trainings for the public in 2025 than ever before, and is on pace to surpass that number in 2026. CPC teaches members of the public how to prepare for disasters and emergency situations, and for all events open to the public, go-bags with basic emergency supplies are provided.

Available Resources:

- DHSES [333111 Emergency and Weather Alerts](#)
- DHSES [Comprehensive Emergency Management Plan](#)
- DHSES [MitigateNY Extreme Heat Resources](#)
- DHSES [Extreme Heat Safety Tips](#)

WORKING WITH COMMUNITIES TO EXPAND COMMUNITY FORESTS

Track: 4 – Prioritize Ecosystem-Based Adaptation

Actions: T4.01, T4.03, T4.05, T4.06 **Involved Agencies:** DEC, AGM

The State is advancing critical resources to support equitable access to greenspace and healthy forest ecosystems. Urban and community forests provide important ecosystem benefits, such as mitigating heat islands, improving air quality, reducing stormwater runoff, and improving public health.

- **Planting 25 million trees, conserving 30% of lands and waters:** DEC continues to prioritize conserving lands, protecting forests and expanding urban canopies, including pursuant to the State’s goals to conserve [30 percent of its lands and waters by 2030](#) and DEC continues to prioritize protecting forests and expanding forest canopies. In contribution to the Governor’s [25 Million Trees](#) initiative. 22,841 tree planting projects across New York State have been recorded by community members, DEC, and partners.
- **Guidance and resources for climate-ready planting:** DEC, AGM, and ESD developed a [“New York Native Plant Supply Priority List”](#) to ensure native, climate-robust plants are prioritized. DEC and The Nature Conservancy have developed a “beginner’s” reforestation guide ([Reforestation and Afforestation Guidance for New York State](#)) for landowners and practitioners. DEC also offers [best practices for taking care of your tree](#) once planted.
- **Funding to support tree equity in urban areas:** DEC’s [Grant Applications](#) webpage connects communities and individuals with funding to plant trees and support urban and community tree canopies, such as the Community Reforestation (CoRe) Grant Program, Urban and Community Forestry grants, Regenerate NY, and Climate Resilient Farming.
- **Investing in the tree supply chain:** Investments in the tree supply chain are expanding access to seedlings and saplings, making tree planting projects across the state possible. The new [Advancing Forest Markets](#) (AFM) grant program helps scale the tree supply chain. The State continues to invest in tree seedling production and nursery capacities, including by modernizing the [Colonel William F. Fox Memorial Saratoga Tree Nursery](#).
- **Supporting maintenance and training:** DEC forestry staff are working with DEC, OPRHP, and DOT staff to update and build consistency in risk tree assessment and chainsaw safety training programs. In addition, in 2025, the Urban and Community Forestry program hosted eight educational events across the state with more than 530 attendees.

Available Resources:

- DEC [UHI Maps](#)
- NYS [25 Million Trees](#)
- DEC & AGM [New York Native Plant Supply Priority List](#)
- DEC [Urban and Community Forestry Grants](#)
- AGM [Advancing Forest Markets](#)
- DEC [Reforestation and Afforestation Guidance for New York State](#)

EXPANDING ACCESS TO COOLING AT HOME

Track: 3 **Action:** T3.01 – Expand access to affordable cooling at home

Lead agency: OTDA **Involved Agency:** DOH

The State continues to support access to affordable cooling at home by providing free air conditioners and introducing utility shutoff protections for customers during extreme heat events.

The OTDA [HEAP Cooling Assistance program](#) supported more than 20,000 households in 2025. In 2025, DOH launched the [Essential Plan Cooling Program](#) to complement HEAP by providing free air conditioners to Essential Plan members with asthma as a pre-existing condition. In 2026, DOH is expanding coverage under the program to include a total of 16 qualifying conditions.

UNIFORM UTILITY SHUTOFF PROTECTIONS

Track: 3 **Action:** T3.18 – Explore options for strengthening customer protections during heat waves

Lead agency: DPS

To further support affordable cooling at home, the PSC approved a [comprehensive statewide policy regarding extreme heat customer protections](#) for the largest investor-owned electric utilities and water utilities. The policy prohibits these utilities from terminating residential customers' service for non-payment during extreme heat events.

EXPANDING RESOURCES TO SUPPORT WORKERS' HEAT HEALTH SAFETY

Track: 2 **Action:** T2.08 – Prevent heat-related injury, illness through guidance, recommendations
T2.09 – Develop recommendations for heat-related injury prevention

Lead agency: DOL **Involved Agency:** DOH

In summer 2024, DOL released employer guidance on how to prevent heat-related injuries and illnesses for outdoor workers. Throughout the rest of 2024, DOL released guides on how to best protect outdoor workers from other extreme weather hazards, including cold, precipitation, and wildfire smoke. All guidance documents are available in English and Spanish. DOL has also supplemented the guidance with the [Extreme Weather Guidance Hub](#), which includes additional resources about extreme weather protection for employers and workers.

In summer 2025, DOL released a template Heat Illness & Injury Prevention Plan (HIIPP) in [English](#) and [Spanish](#). This resource is available for employers to offer a simple work site plan about how they will keep workers safe during extreme heat, and to help employers better adhere to DOL's worker protection guidance.

PROTECTING WORKERS FROM EXTREME HEAT

Track: 2 **Action:** T2.09 – Support heat-related injury prevention for public workers

Lead agency: DOL **Involved Agency:** DOH

DOL continues to implement the National Heat Emphasis Program via the Public Employee Safety and Health (PESH) and On-site Consultation programs. This includes heat-specific employer support through field consultations, compliance assistance, and enforcement.

INTEGRATING RESILIENCE ASSESSMENTS IN HOME & BUILDING ENERGY ASSESSMENTS

Track: 3 **Action:** T3.06 – Enhance home energy assessments to incorporate resilience

Lead agency: NYSERDA, HCR

NYSERDA continues to incorporate climate resiliency into home energy assessments, including through [FlexTech energy studies](#). These studies evaluate eligible buildings for opportunities to reduce energy costs and incorporate clean energy into capital planning. The FlexTech program creates actionable recommendations on clean energy projects for building owners. In 2025, the program also included an evaluation of resiliency measures associated with these clean energy solutions (including those associated with extreme heat) to prevent damage to and maintain operation of critical infrastructure.

WORKING WITH COMMUNITY ORGANIZATIONS TO PROTECT WORKERS

Track: 2 **Action:** T2.10 – Protect workers' health through engagement with local partners

Lead agency: DOL **Involved Agency:** DOH

DOL developed a [bilingual heat safety wallet card](#) to distribute to workers in the field. DOL, partner organizations, and local governments printed the card for field distribution throughout summer 2025, and the card is available on DOL's webpage for anyone who wants to print them for distribution.

ACCELERATING THE TRANSITION TO ELECTRIC PUBLIC TRANSIT FLEETS

Track: 2 **Action:** T3.20 – Accelerate the transition of buses and agency fleets

Lead agency: MTA

MTA completed deployments of charging infrastructure at several key locations, resulting in 82 battery-electric buses in service across all five boroughs of New York City. These buses establish the operational foundation for expansions in future years. MTA is advancing charging infrastructure deployment at additional locations to expand capacity and support deployment of additional fleet vehicles, including at Queens Village. There, installed charging infrastructure will support 132 automated overhead charging stations, creating the largest battery-electric bus charging hub in the system.

HEAT RESILIENCE IN MANAGED SPACES

Track: 3 **Action:** T3.16 – Develop and implement facility-specific heat response plans
T3.17 – Assess cooling in congregate settings

Lead agency: DOCCS

DOCCS developed a [Heat Mitigation Plan](#)⁶, which informs and guides facility-level preparations for heat-related events for 2026. As part of this effort, the State continues to assess the feasibility of cooling stations to protect occupants of institutional and congregate spaces, including DOCCS facilities, and is piloting a variety of options to provide cooling, such as misting fans.

⁶ Pursuant to S7781-A/ A9169-A

SUPPORTING LOCAL COMMUNITY PREPAREDNESS PLANNING

Track: 2 **Action:** T2.01 – Support regional and local heat emergency plans

Lead agency: DOH, DHSES

DOH is collaborating with Cornell University to develop a tabletop exercise for local health departments and emergency managers to strengthen local preparedness plans for extreme heat events. The tabletop exercise was presented to counties during DHSES's Risk Communication training in March 2025 and at the NYS Public Health Partnership Conference in April 2026.

ADVANCING RESEARCH AND INNOVATION

Track: 1 **Action:** T1.10 – Conduct essential research on the impacts of extreme heat
T1.09 – Support innovation for passive, resilient, and safe cooling

Lead agency: NYSERDA

NYSERDA is supporting research and innovation to better understand heat-health impacts, support community preparedness and planning for extreme heat, and advance innovative cooling solutions. NYSERDA is funding two research projects to identify data gaps for heat-vulnerable populations and to assess approaches for better understanding the interactions of climate and indoor air quality. Additionally, as part of Phase 2 of the [“Green Cooling for Extreme Heat” Innovation Challenge](#), over \$3 million was awarded in 2025 to innovative green cooling technologies. Awarded contracts are under negotiation and expected to be announced once they have been executed.

OTHER MILESTONES

Milestone	Action	Summary
Enhanced UHI maps and tools	T1.02	DEC is collaborating with SUNY ESF and Davey Tree to enhance and expand on existing maps and tools to identify urban heat islands. Maps are available online.
Engagement with climate youth organizations	T1.05	DEC participated in several climate youth summits across the state. Staff engaged young leaders to discuss extreme heat, its impacts, and explore solutions.
Updated HVI	T1.07	DOH is evaluating and updating the State's Heat Vulnerability Index .
Evaluate HeatRisk tools for use in New York State	T1.08	DOH evaluated HeatRisk forecasts for their applicability and use in New York State and published the findings of the evaluation in the CDC Morbidity and Mortality Weekly Report .
New tabletop scenario planning tool	T2.01	DOH is collaborating with Cornell University to develop a tabletop exercise to plan for extreme heat.
Extreme heat media campaign	T2.06	DOH manages an annual media campaign on extreme heat. The campaign highlights OTDA's HEAP benefit, increases awareness of extreme heat, promotes DOH's Cooling Center Finder, and distributes emergency messaging during extreme heat events. The campaign runs in English and Spanish throughout the summer.

Extreme heat equipment credit	T2.08	Governor Kathy Hochul announced the launch of NYSIF's new Extreme Heat Equipment Credit in 2025 and its continuation in 2026 . The credit helps qualifying small businesses protect their workers through the purchase of personal protective equipment (PPE) and supplies designed to minimize the effects of heat exposure.
Protecting construction workers	T2.09	The DOT Construction Worker Safety Manual includes additional information on extreme heat.
Incorporating extreme heat in school extreme weather action plans	T3.01	Education law was amended to require all public schools to develop an extreme heat policy. Schools are incorporating these policies into their extreme weather action plans.
New resources to support solar for grid resilience	T3.07	HCR, in partnership with NYSERDA, launched a solar evaluation tool for residential building developers to assess solar feasibility (technically and financially) and released a new Multifamily Solar Fund Program deployed through HCR with funding from NYSERDA.
New Inclusive Storage Incentive	T3.07	NYSERDA launched a new Inclusive Storage Incentive , which provides enhanced incentives to customer-sited energy storage projects benefiting DACs.
Advanced energy code adopted	T3.09	The State adopted an advanced energy code that is more energy-efficient than the most recently published national model energy code.
Incorporating extreme heat in school planning standards	T3.14	NYSED updated its Draft Manual of Planning Standards for school buildings (MPS) to include a section on cooling. Multiple State agencies continue to develop strategies and resources for heat mitigation.
Incorporating extreme heat in DOT's Resilience Improvement Plan	T3.19	DOT included EHAP-related sections in its 2025 Draft Resilience Improvement Plan, and DOT is participating in a collaborative effort to develop streetscape guidelines, including for vegetation planting, to help address urban heat island locations.
Funding for projects that support agricultural water quality, which address extreme heat	T4.04	In the most recent round of the State's Agricultural Nonpoint Source Pollution Abatement and Control Program , \$25 million is available for projects that help New York's farmers to support agricultural water quality conservation projects, including projects that address soil health to alleviate food, crop, and soil damage from extreme heat and drought conditions. The program functions as part of the Agricultural Environmental Management (AEM) framework, a broader effort that helps farmers achieve higher levels of environmental stewardship and more efficient, cost-effective farming systems.

Grants support 51 organizations to create community growing spaces	T4.05	\$2.5 million was awarded to 51 organizations across the state through Round 3 of New York State's Urban Farms and Community Gardens Grant Program . The program supports community growing spaces and recognizes their impact on local food resiliency and food security for New Yorkers. Community gardens and urban farms help to reduce the stress of the heat island effect on urban communities.
Grants help advance climate and extreme heat resilience at farms	T4.05	The Climate Resilient Farming (CRF) Grant Program is awarding \$25 million to over 100 farms across the state. Funded projects aim to help farmers reduce greenhouse gas emissions, protect water quality, protect and enhance soil health, and increase farm resiliency to the effects of a changing climate, including drought and extreme heat.

LEARN MORE

[ON.NY.GOV/EXTREMEHEAT](https://on.ny.gov/extremeheat)

Contact us at extreme-heat@dec.ny.gov